Marcus Okafor

Senior Software Engineer

Distributed Systems | Platform Engineering | Technical Leadership

Seattle, Washington

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Profile

Senior software engineer with 12+ years of experience designing and operating high-availability platforms in payments, logistics, and cloud infrastructure. Combines hands-on systems engineering with technical strategy, staff-level mentorship, and a record of translating complex modernization programs into measurable business outcomes.

Professional Experience

Principal Software Engineer — 2021 – Present

Summit Payments, Seattle, WA

- Set technical direction for a 25-engineer payments platform processing more than USD 4 billion in annual transaction volume across North America.
- Led the incremental decomposition of a monolithic authorization service into independently deployable domain services, improving p99 latency by 41% and enabling multiple production releases per week.
- Designed a multi-region resilience program spanning failover, data replication, and disaster-recovery exercises; critical payment APIs reached 99.99% availability.
- Introduced lightweight architecture RFCs, reliability scorecards, and quarterly technical planning adopted by six product domains.
- Mentored five senior engineers, including two who progressed into staff-level technical leadership roles.

Staff Software Engineer — 2017 – 2021

HarborGrid Technologies, San Francisco, CA

- Architected an event-driven shipment-tracking platform that processed 18 million daily location events using Go, Kafka, Kubernetes, and Cassandra.
- Delivered capacity-planning and autoscaling capabilities that lowered annual infrastructure expenditure by 28% while preserving peak-season performance.
- Partnered with product, operations, and data teams to launch predictive exception workflows, reducing manual case handling by 30%.
- Led incident reviews and observability improvements that reduced mean time to restore service for tier-one systems by 38%.

Senior Software Engineer — 2014 – 2017

Pioneer Cloud Services, Boston, MA

- Built multi-tenant provisioning APIs and developer tooling used by more than 40 internal engineering teams.
- Established service templates, automated testing conventions, and threat-modeling practices for a rapidly growing cloud-services organization.

Selected Outcomes

Modernization: Delivered a three-year migration roadmap that retired 14 legacy services without a major customer-facing outage.

Reliability: Created incident-command training and post-incident learning practices, reducing repeat high-severity incidents by 52%.

Developer velocity: Sponsored a “golden path” for new services and CI/CD, reducing median production-readiness time from 10 days to 2 days.

Technology Leadership

Languages: Go, Java, Python, TypeScript, SQL
Platforms: AWS, Kubernetes, Terraform, Docker, GitHub Actions
Systems: Kafka, gRPC, PostgreSQL, DynamoDB, Redis, OpenTelemetry
Practices: Distributed systems design, API governance, SRE, security reviews, technical roadmaps, mentoring

Education & Recognition

MS, Software Engineering, Carnegie Mellon University 2013 – 2014
BS, Computer Science, Georgia Institute of Technology 2009 – 2013

Engineering Excellence Award (2024) | Patent co-inventor: adaptive workload routing (2022)
Speaker: "Designing for Failure in Payment Systems," QCon San Francisco (2025)